

The classes are placed inside the `app/Http/Resources` directory of your application. Moreover, resources extend the `Illuminate\Http\Resources\Json\JsonResource` class. A resource collection can be created using the `-collection` flag. Alternatively, you can provide the word 'Collection' in the resource name, which will be automatically detected by the Laravel framework. It is to be noted that the collection resources extend the `Illuminate\Http\Resources\Json\ResourceCollection` class.



Interact with JSON effectively using Eloquent ORM

If you examine a resource class, it defines a `toArray()` method, which returns the array of attributes that needs to be converted to JSON. Take a look at the sample code snippet:

```
public function toArray($request)
{
    return [
        'id' => $this->id,
        'firstname' => $this->firstname,
        'address' => $this->address,
        'created_at' => $this->created_at,
        'updated_at' => $this->updated_at,
    ];
}
```

The model properties can be accessed with the help of the `$this` variable. The `collection()` method should be created if you would like to return a collection of resources in the form of several pages. It is possible to customize the resource collection response by creating a dedicated resource as given below:

```
php artisan make:resource UserCollection
```